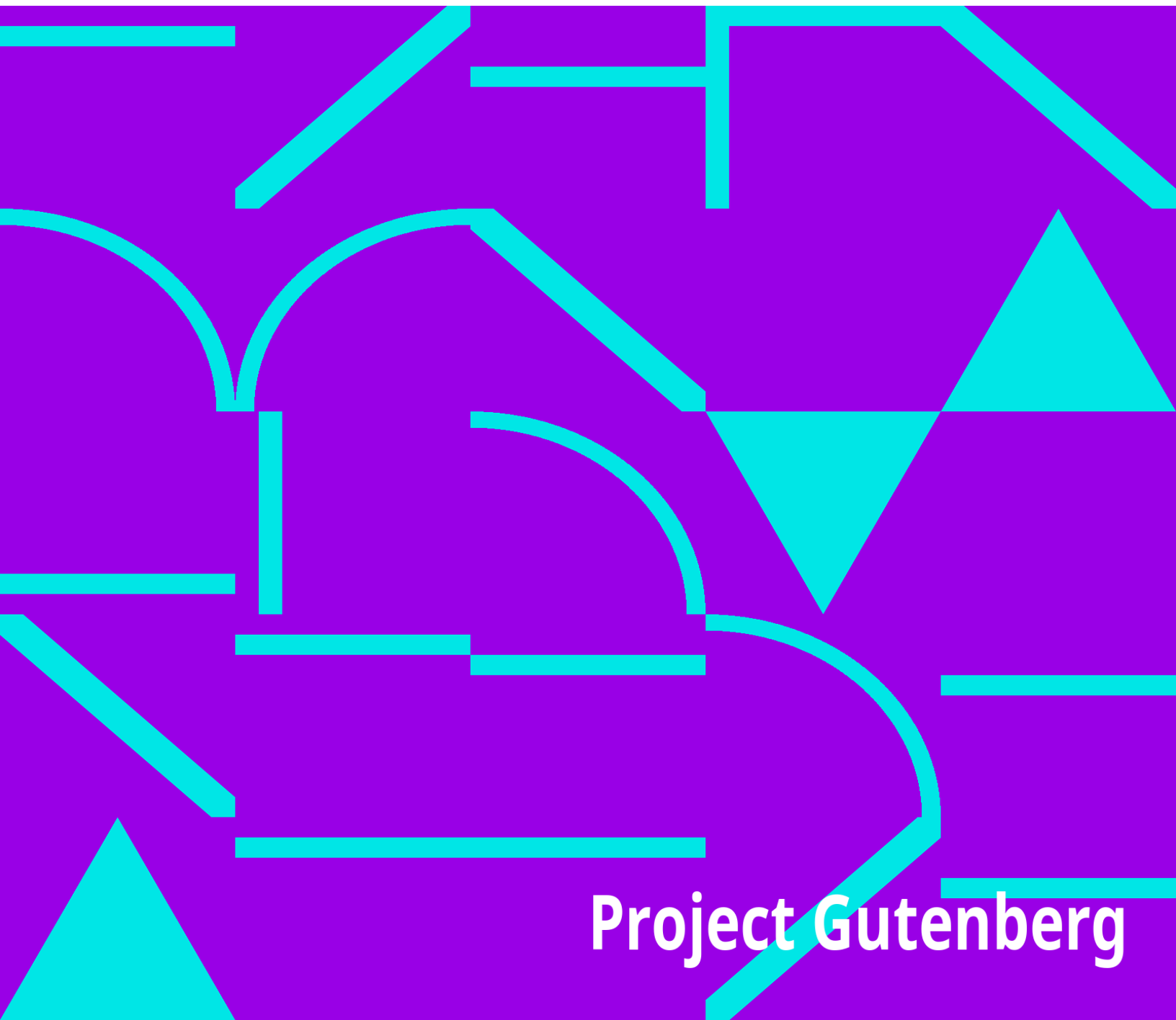


Encomium artis medicae

Desiderius Erasmus

An abstract geometric pattern composed of various red lines and shapes, including straight lines, arcs, and triangles, set against a black background. The pattern is dense and covers the lower half of the image.

Project Gutenberg

Encomium artis medicae

Desiderius Erasmus

Project Gutenberg

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Encomium artis medicae

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Encomium artis medicae

Author: Desiderius Erasmus

Release date: August 20, 2005 [eBook #16561]

Most recently updated: December 12, 2020

Language: Latin

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/16561

Credits: Produced by Louise Hope, Frank van Drogen and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at <https://www.pgdp.net>. This file was produced from images generously made available by The Internet Archive/Canadian Libraries

***** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK ENCOMIUM
ARTIS MEDICAE *****

A few typographical errors have been corrected. They have been marked with
popups.



ENCOMIUM ARTIS MEDICÆ
DESIDERIO ERASMO ROTERODAMO AUTORE.

DE LOF DER GENEESKUNDE
VAN
DESIDERIUS ERASMUS.

Erasmus Roterodamus
D. Henrico Afinio Lyrano

insigni Medico
S. D.

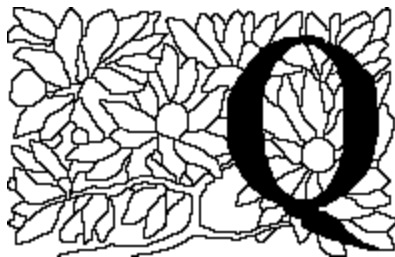
Nuper dum bibliothecam recenseo, doctissime Afini, venit in manus oratio quaedam olim mihi nihil non experiēti, in laudem artis medicae declamata; continuo visum est orationem non optimam optimo dicare medico, ut vel tui nominis lenocinio studiosorum centuriis commendetur.

Erit hoc interim mei in te animi quaecunque documentum, dum dabitur aliud nostra necessitudine dignius.

Bene vale.

Lovanii tertio Idus Martias Anno MDXVIII.

DECLAMATIO ERASMI ROTERODAMI
IN LAUDEM ARTIS MEDICÆ.



Attentio. uo saepius est ars
medicinae, meditatis et elaboratis
orationibus, hoc ex loco, apud
plerosque vestrum praedicata,
idque a viris singulari facundia
praeditis, auditores celeberrimi,
hoc mihi sane minus est fiduciaē, me vel
tantae rei, vel aurium vestrarum
expectationi satisfacturum. Neque enim rem prope divinam
nostra facile assequetur infantia, neque vulgaris oratio de
re toties audita taedium possit effugere.

 *Propositio.* Verumtamen ne salutari maiorum instituto videar deesse, qui solenni encomio juventutis animos ad huius praeclarae scientiae studium, admirationem, amorem, excitandos, accendendos, inflammandosque censuerunt, experiar et ipse pro mea virili (siquidem me dicentem adjutabit vestra tum attentio, tum humanitas, favore candido prosequens, quem ad hoc muneris vestra adegit autoritas) medicae facultatis dignitatem, auctoritatem, usum, necessitatem, non dicam explicare, quod prorsus infiniti fuerit negotii, sed summatim modo perstringere, ac veluti confertissimas locupletissimae cujuspian reginae opes, per transennam (ut aiunt) studiosorum exhibere conspectibus.

Laudandi ratio per comparisonem. Cuius quidem ea vel praecipua laus est, primum quod nullis omnino praeconiis indiget, ipsa abunde per se vel utilitate, vel necessitate commendata mortalibus. Deinde quod toties iam a tam praeclaris ingeniis praedicata, semper tamen novam laudum suarum materiam, ingeniis etiam parum foecundis ex sese suppeditat, ut nihil necesse sit, eam vulgato more invidiosis illis contentionibus, non sine caeterarum disciplinarum contumelia depraedicare. Quin illud magis metuendum, ne domesticas illius dotes, ne germanam ac nativam amplitudinem, ne majestatem humana conditione maiorem, mortalis oratio non assequatur. Tantum abest, ut vel aliena contumelia, vel asciticiis Rhetorum fucis, aut amplificationum praestigiis sit attollenda. *gnômê.* Mediocrium est formarum, deformiorum comparatione, aut cultus lenociniis commendari; res per se vereque praeclaras, satis est vel nudas oculis ostendisse.

Dignitas et auctoritas medicinae.

Inventio artis. Iam primum enim (ut ad rem festinemus) reliquae artes quoniam nulla non magnam aliquam vitae commoditatem attulit, summo quidem in pretio fuere.

Verum medicinae quondam tam admirabilis fuit humano generi inventio, tam dulcis experientia, ut eius autores, aut plane pro diis habiti sint, velut Apollo, et huius filius Aesculapius, imo (quod ait Plinius) singula quosdam inventa deorum numero addiderunt, aut certe divinis honoribus digni sint existimati, velut Asclepiades, quem Illyrici numinis instar receptum Herculi in honoribus aequarunt. *Torquet exemplum in suum commodum.* Non equidem probo quod fecit antiquitas, affectum sane ac iudicium laudo, quippe quae recte et senserit et declararit, docto fidoque medico nullum satis dignum praemium persolvi posse.

A difficultate. Etenim si quis secum reputet, quam multiplex in corporibus humanis diversitas, quanta ex aetatibus, sexu, regionibus, coelo, educatione, studiis, usu varietas, quam infinita in tot milibus herbarum (ne quid interim dicam de caeteris remediis) quae alibi aliae nascuntur, discrimina. Tum quot sint morborum genera, quae trecenta nominatim fuisse prodita scribit Plinius, exceptis generum partibus, quarum omnium quam nullus sit numerus, facile perpendet, qui tantum norit, quot formas in se febris vocabulum complectatur, ut ex uno caetera aestimentur; exceptis his, qui quotidie novi accrescunt, neque secus accrescunt, quam si de composito cum arte nostra bellum suscepisse videantur. *Longum hyperbaton.* Exceptis venenorum plus mille periculis, quorum quot species sunt, tot sunt mortis genera, totidem remediorum differentias flagitantia. Exceptis casibus quotidianis lapsuum, ruinarum, ruptionum, adustionum, luxationum, vulnerum, atque his consimilium, quae prope cum ipso morborum agmine ex aequo certant. Denique qui cogitet, quanta sit in corporum coelestium observatione difficultas, quae nisi cognoris, saepenumero venenum erit, quod in remedium datur. Ne quid interim commemorem saepe fallaces morborum notas, sive coloris habitum spectes, sive lotii signa rimeris, sive pulsus harmoniam observes, velut

hoc agentibus malis, ut hostem medicum fallant et imponant. Tantum undique sese offundit difficultatum, ut mihi difficile sit omnes vel oratione prosequi.

Sed ut dicere coeperam, has omnes rerum varietates studio persequi, obscuritates ingenio assequi, difficultates industria pervincere, ac penetratis terrae fibris, excussis undique totius naturae arcanis, ex omnibus herbis, fruticibus, arboribus, animantibus, gemmis, ex ipsis denique venenis, cunctis humanae vitae malis efficacia quaerere remedia, atque horum opportunum usum ex tot autoribus, tot disciplinis, imo et ab ipsis sideribus petere. Haec inquam, tam abdita rimari cura, tam ardua viribus animi adipisci, tam multa memoria complecti, tam necessaria ad salutem universi mortalium generis in commune proferre, *Divina res medicina*. nonne prorsus homine maius ac plane divinum quiddam fuisse videtur? Absit invidia verbis. Liceat id quod vero verius est ingenue praedicare. Non me jacto, sed artem ipsam effero. *Laus ab effectu*. Etenim si dare vitam proprium dei munus est, certe datam tueri, jamque fugientem retinere, deo proximum fateamur oportet. Quamquam ne prius quidem illud, quod nos soli deo proprium esse volumus, medicorum arti detraxit antiquitas, ut credula, ita gratissima. *Ars medicorum et mortuos excitare credita est*. Nam Aesculapii quidem ope Tyndaridam, et post eum complures ab Orco in lucem redisse credidit. Asclepiades hominem exanimatum, elatum, comploratumque ab rogo domum vivum reduxisse legitur. Xanthus historicus catulum leonis occisum, praeterea et hominem, quem Draco occiderat, vitae redditum fuisse, posteris prodidit, herba quam halin nominant. Ad haec Juba, in Africa quendam herba revocatum ad vitam, testis est. Neque vero laboraverim, si sint apud quos haec fide careant. Certe (quod agimus) admirationem artis tanto magis implent, quanto magis supra fidem veri sunt, et immensum esse fateri cogunt id quod vero supersit. Quamquam quantum

ad eum attinet, qui vitae redditur, quid refert utrum anima denuo in artus relictos divinitus reponatur, an penitus in corpore sepulta, morbiue victoris oppressa viribus, arte curaque medici suscitetur atque eliciatur, iamque certo migratura retineatur? An non pene paria sunt mortuum restituere, et mox moriturum servare? Atqui permultos nominatim recenset Plinius libro historiae mundanae septimo, qui iam elati partim in ipso rogo, partim post dies complusculos revixerint.

Miraculum est, quod paucis dedit casus. Et non magis mirandum, quod quotidie multis largitur ars nostra? Etiam si hanc deo Opt. Max. debemus, cui nihil non debemus, ne quis haec a me putet arrogantius dicta quam verius. Complurium morborum ea vis est, ut certa mors sint, nisi praesens adsit medicus, veluti stupor is, qui mulieribus potissimum solet accidere, veluti syncopis profunda, paralysis, apoplexia. Neque desunt ulli vel seculo, vel genti sua in hanc rem exempla. Hic qui mortem ingruentem arte sua depellit, qui vitam subito oppressam revocat, nonne ceu numen quoddam dextrum ac propitium semper habendus est? Quot censes homines ante diem sepultos fuisse priusquam medicorum solertia morborum vires, et remediorum naturas deprehenderat? *Initium vitae medicis debetur.* Quot hodie mortalium milia vivunt, valentque, qui ne nati quidem essent, nisi eadem haec ars, et tot nascendi discriminibus remedia, et obstetricandi rationem reperisset? Adeo statim in ipso vitae limine, et pariens simul et nascens salutarem medicorum opem miserabili voce implorat. Horum arti vitam debet, et qui nondum vitam accepit, dum per eam prohibentur abortus, dum mulieri seminis recipiendi retinendique vis confertur, dum pariendi facultas datur. *paroimia* Quod si vere dictum est illud Deus est juvare mortalem, profecto mea sententia aut nusquam locum habebit illud nobile Graecorum adagium *anthrôpos anthrôpou daimonion*, aut in medico fido proboque locum habebit, qui non juvat

modo verum etiam servat. An non igitur ingratitudine ipsa videatur ingrator, ac ipse prope vita indignus, qui medicinam alteram secundum deum, vitae parentem, tutricem, servatricem, vindicem non amet, non honoret, non suspiciat, non veneretur? *Ab utilitate perpetua.* Cuius praesidiis nunquam ulli non est opus. Nam reliquis quidem artibus nec semper nec omnes egemus. Huius utilitate mortalium omnis vita constat. Nam fac abesse morbos, fac omnibus prosperam adesse valetudinem, tamen hanc qui poterimus tueri, nisi medicus ciborum salutarium ac noxiorum discrimen, nisi totius victus, quam Graeci diaetam vocant, rationem doceat?

Senectam remoratur ars medicorum. Grave mortalibus est onus senecta, quam non magis licet effugere quam mortem ipsam. Atque ea medicorum opera multis contingit, tum serius, tum multo etiam levior. Neque enim fabula est, quinta, quam vocant, essentia senio depulso hominem velut abjecto exuvio rejuvenescere, cum extent aliquot huius rei testes.

Totum hominem curat medicus. Neque vero corporis tantum, quae vilior hominis pars est, curam gerit, imo totius hominis curam agit, etiamsi Theologus ab animo, medicus a corpore sumat initium. Siquidem propter arctissimam amborum inter se cognationem et copulam, ut animi vitia redundant in corpus, ita vicissim corporis morbi animae vigorem aut impediunt, aut etiam extinguunt. Quis aequae pertinax suasor abstinentiae, sobrietatis, moderandae irae, fugiendae tristitiae, vitandae crapulae, amoris abjiciendi, temperandae Veneris, atque medicus? Quis efficacius suadet aegroto, ut si vivere velit, et salutarem experiri medici opem, prius animum a vitiorum colluvie repurget? Idem quoties vel diaetetica ratione, vel ope pharmaceutica bilem atram minuit, labantes cordis vires reficit, cerebri spiritus fulcit, mentis organa purgat, ingenium emendat, memoriae domicilium sarcit, totumque

animi habitum commutat in melius, nonne per exteriorem, ut vocant, hominem, et interiorem servat? Qui phreneticum, lethargicum, maniacum, sideratum, lymphatum restituit, nonne totum restituit hominem? Theologus efficit ut homines a vitiis resipiscant, at medicus efficit, ut sit qui possit resipiscere. Frustra ille medicus sit animae, si jam fugerit anima, cui paratur antidotus. Cum impium hominem subito corripuit paralysis, apoplexia, aut alia quaedam praesentanea pestis, quae vitam prius adimat, quam vacet de castiganda cogitare vita, hunc qui restituit, alioquin infeliciter in suis sceleribus sepeliendum, nonne quodammodo tum corpus, tum animum ab inferis revocat? In eum certe locum reponit hominem, ut ei in manu jam sit, si velit, aeternam mortem fugere. Quid suadebit lethargico Theologus, qui suadentem non audiat? Quid movebit phreneticum, nisi medicus prius atram bilem repurgarit?

Pietas caeteraeque virtutes, quibus Christiana constat felicitas, ab animo potissimum pendent, haud infitior. Caeterum quoniam is corpori illigatus, corporeis organis velit nolit utitur, fit ut bona pars bonae mentis a corporis habitu pendeat. *Temperaturam corporis emendat medicus.* Permultos homines infelix corporis temperatura, quam Graeci modo krasin modo systêma vocant, velut invitos ac reclamantes, ad peccandum pertrahit, dum animus inessor frustra moderatur habenas, frustra subdit calcaria, sed equum ferocientem in praecipitium sequi cogitur. *A simili.* Animus videt, animus audit sed si oculos occuparit glaucoma, si aurium meatus crassus humor obsederit, frustra vim suam habet animus. Odit animus, irascitur animus, at vitiosus humor mentis organa obsidens in causa est, ut oderis, quem amore dignum iudices, irasceris cui nolis irasci. Philosophiae summam in hoc sitam esse fatetur *Plato.* Plato, si rationi pareant affectus, atque ad eam rem praecipuus est adjutor medicus, hoc agens ut ea pars hominis vigeat sapiatque, cuius arbitrio geruntur, quaecunque cum laude geruntur. Si

hominis vocabulo censentur indigni, qui pecudum ritu rapiuntur cupiditatibus, huius nominis dignitatem bona ex parte debemus medicis.

Principibus maxime necessarius medicus. Id cum maximum sit in singulis ac privatis, quanto praeclarius est beneficium, cum id praestatur in principe? Nulla fortuna magis est obnoxia malis huiusmodi, quam felicissimorum regum. Quos autem rerum tumultus ciet unius homunculi vitiatum cerebrum? Frustra reclament qui sunt a consiliis, furis o princeps, ad te redi, ni medicus arte sua neque volenti, neque sentienti suam mentem reddiderit. *Ab exemplo.* Si Caligulae fidus adfuisset medicus, non usque ad pugionum ac venenorum scrinia in perniciem humani generis insanisset. Atque ob eam sane causam publica consuetudine receptum est apud omnes orbis nationes, ne princeps usquam gentium agat absque medicis. *Honos habitus medicinae.*

Honora medicum. Proinde cordati principes nulli unquam arti plus honoris habuerunt, quam medicinae. Quandoquidem Erasistratus (ut reliquos taceam) Aristotelis ex filia nepos, ob Antiochum regem sanatum, centum talentis donatus est a Ptolemaeo huius filio. Quin et divinae literae jubent medico suum haberi honorem, non tantum ob utilitatem, verum etiam ob necessitatem, ut in caeteros benemeritos ingratitudo sit, in medicum impietas, quippe qui tamquam beneficii divini adjutor, id arte sua tuetur, quod optimum nobis et carissimum largitus est deus, videlicet vitam.

A similibus. Parentibus nihil non debemus, quod per hos vitae munus accepisse quodammodo videmur. Plus mea sententia debetur medico, cui toties debemus, quod parentibus semel dumtaxat debemus, si tamen illis debemus. Pietatem debemus ei, qui hostem a cervicibus depulit, et medico non magis debemus, qui pro nobis servandis cum tot capitalibus vitae hostibus quotidie

depugnat? Reges ceu deos suspicimus, quia vitae necisque jus habere creduntur, qui tamen ut possint occidere, certe vitam non aliter dare possunt, nisi quatenus non eripiunt, quemadmodum servare dicuntur latrones, si quem non jugulent, nec aliam tamen vitam dare possunt, quam corporis. At quanto propius ad divinam benignitatem accedit medici beneficium, hominem iam inferis destinatum arte, ingenio, cura, fideque sua, velut ex ipsis mortis faucibus retrahentis? Aliis in rebus profuisse sit officium, caeterum in certo corporis animique periculo servasse, plus quam pietas est. Adde his quod quicquid in homine magnum est, eruditio, virtus, naturae dotes, aut si quid aliud, id omne medicorum arti acceptum feramus oportet, quatenus id servat, sine quo ne reliqua quidem queant subsistere. Si omnia propter hominem, et hominem ipsum servat medicus, nimirum omnium nomine gratia debetur medico.

Sanitatis custos medicus. Si non vivit, qui vivit morbis obnoxius, et vitam salubrem aut reddit aut tuetur medicus, an non convenit hunc ceu vitae parentem agnoscere? Si res exoptanda est immortalitas, hanc medicorum industria, quoad licet, meditat, quae vitam in longum prorogat.

Exempla. Quid enim hic notissima referam exempla, Pythagoram, Chrysippum, Platonem, Catonem censorium, Antonium, Castorem, cumque his innumerabiles, quorum plerique medicinae observatione, vitam ab omni morbo liberam neque fatiscente ingenii vigore, neque concussa memoriae soliditate, neque fractis aut labefactatis sensibus, ultra centesimum annum prorogarunt? An non istuc est immortalitatis, quam speramus, hic iam nunc imaginem quandam exhibere? *Christus non aegrotavit.* Christus ipse immortalitatis autor ac vindex unicus corpus assumpsit, mortale quidem illud, sed tamen nullis morbis obnoxium. Crucem non horruit, morbos horruit. An non pulcherrimum fuerit, nos principem nostrum in hoc quoque pro viribus imitari? Apostolos, quorum nemo fere non

multam vixit aetatem, caesos legimus, interfectos legimus, aegrotasse non legimus. Quocunque pacto hoc illis contigit, certe praestat idem ars medicorum, quod illis praestitit sua felicitas. Nec enim audiendos arbitror, qui nobis non minus indocte, quam impudenter solent illud objicere: *Confutatio*. Virtus in infirmitate perficitur, somniantes Paulum gravi capitis dolori fuisse obnoxium, cum ille infirmitatem vel animi tentationem, vel quod vero propius est, improborum hominum molestam insectationem appellet. *Donum curationis*. Atque idem ille Paulus, inter apostolicas dotes, donum curationis recensuit.

Iam auget et illud non levi argumento medicinae gloriam, quod et Caesarearum legum majestas, et pontificiarum autoritas sese ultro medicorum iudicio submittit, velut in quaestionibus pubertatum, partuum ac veneficiorum. Item in quaestionibus aliquot ad matrimonium facientibus. O nova dignitas medicinae. Agitur de capite hominis, et iudicis sententia pendet ex medici praeiudicio. Summi pontificis pietas, si quid indulget, in nonnullis non aliter indulget, nisi medicorum accedat calculus. Atque in decretis Romanus pontifex episcopum eum, qui delatus fuerat tamquam foedo immanique morbo obnoxius, ex medicae rei iudicio censet aut amovendum episcopatu, aut suo loco restituendum. Divus item Augustinus ex medicorum consilio fieri jubet, quod faciendum est, etiamsi nolit aegrotus. Idem honorem medico debitum, hoc est artis et industriae praemium, recte eripi scribit ab eo qui detinet, velut ab injusto possessore et quod alienum est mala fide occupante. Quin ii quoque, qui conceptis precaminibus, daemones impios e corporibus humanis exigunt, non raro in consilium adhibent, velut in his morbis, qui secretis rationibus quaedam sensuum organa spiritusque vitiant, et adeo daemoniacam speciem imitantur, ut nisi a peritissimis medicis discerni non queant, sive sunt crassiores aliqui daemones, ut fertur

illorum varia natura, qui medicam etiam opem sentiant, sive morbus adeo penitus intimis animi recessibus insidet, ut a corpore videatur alienus. In cuius rei fidem, dum ex innumeris mihi compertum exemplum refero, quaeso ut me patienter audiat.

Exemplum. Panaceum celeberrimi nominis medicum adolescens colui, is me teste quendam restituit, nomine Phlyarium, patria Spoletanum, qui ex vermibus in novum maniae genus inciderat, ita ut in morbo probe teutonice loqueretur, quod (uti constabat) sanus nunquam potuerat. Quis imperitus rei medicae non hunc daemoniacum vel dejerasset etiam? At is hominem facili paratoque remedio menti reddidit. Redditus sibi, teutonice nec loquebatur, nec intelligebat. *Detorquet.* Quod si quis hunc vere daemoniacum fuisse contendat, ea sane res vel maxime medicorum illustrat artem, cui compertum est et daemones impios parere, quemadmodum in restituenda vita, ita et in exigendis spiritibus divinae virtutis tum ministrae, tum aemulae. Neque vero deerant, qui factum hoc magicis artibus tribuebant, quorum ego calumniam arti nostrae gloriae laudique verto, per quam ea praestantur, quae vulgus hominum humanis viribus praestari posse non credit.

Quibus culta medicina. Optimo igitur jure priscis seculis, cum nondum sordidi quaestus et spurcae voluptates vitiassent omnia, medendi ars inter omnes una divinis ac summatibus viris, opulentissimis regibus, clarissimis senatoribus praecipue cordi fuit, nec alia mortalium generi gratior. *Moses.*

Orpheus. Siquidem Moses ille magnus, non alia ratione quam artis medicae, cibos suos distinxisse creditur. Orpheus, Graecorum vetustissimus, de viribus herbarum nonnulla prodidisse legitur. *Homerus.* Homerus ipse, citra controversiam, unicus ingeniorum fons, plurimus est et in herbarum commemoratione, et in laude medicorum.

Moly. Is et Moly nobis depinxit, herbarum omnium (teste Plinio) laudatissimam, efficacem adversus veneficia, cuius inventionem Mercurio tribuit, hac Ulyssem suum adversus Circes pocula praemuniens. *Nepenthes.* Idem nepenthes indicat in conviviis adhibendum, quod moerorem tristitiamque discutiat. *Machaon.* *Paeon.*

Chiron. Porro Machaonem, Paeonem, Chironem, Podalirium, ut hac arte praestantes, saepicule non sine honore commemorat, quorum arte non solum heroibus, verum ipsis etiam diis subventum esse fingit, illud videlicet subindicans, summis etiam principibus medicorum praesidiis opus esse, atque horum vitam medicis in manu esse, qui in caeteros omnes jus vitae ac necis habere videntur. Quid quod idem Poeta libro Iliados undecimo, huius artis professionem longe pulcherrimo nobilitavit elogio, cum ait: *iatros gar anêr pollôn antaxios allôn* Unum medicum pluri habendum, quam caeterorum hominum permultos. Rursum alibi medicum ita notat, ut dicat eum eruditum in omnibus, palam testans id quod res est, hanc artem non una aut altera disciplina, sed omnium artium cognitione circuloque, tum praeter exactum ingenium, multo etiam rerum usu constare. Pythagoras ille Samius, cui divinitatem quandam tribuebat antiquitas, de naturis herbarum nobile volumen reliquisse legitur. Atque ut Platonem, Aristotelem, Theophrastum, Chrysippum, Catonem censorium, Varronem praeteream, quibus studio fuit hanc artem suis vel studiis, vel negotiis admiscere, Mithridatem Ponti regem, non perinde regnum, alioqui locupletissimum, non tam unius et viginti linguarum miraculum, quam rei medicae peritia nobilitavit, vereque magnum virum declaravit, qui artis huius commentationes, et exemplaria, effectusque in arcanis reliquit, ut autor est Plinius. Cuius et hodie nobile theriacae genus nomine celebratur. Nunc fere regium habetur, aleam ludere, venari, nugae agere. At olim populi Romani principibus nihil magis erat curae, quam ut ex longinquo novis importandis

herbis, rem medicam adjuvarent, neque populo illi tum
orbis domino aliud erat munus gratius.

Christus ipse medicus. Quid quod Christus ipse,
disciplinarum omnium et autor et princeps, sese non
Iureconsultum, non Rhetorem, non Philosophum, sed
Medicum professus est, dum de se loquens negat opus esse
medico iis, qui bene habeant, dum Samaritanus vulneribus
oleum ac vinum infundit, dum sputum terrae mixtum illinit
oculis caeci. Quid quod idem hac potissimum
commendatione, cum adhuc orbi esset ignotus, sese
paulatim in animos atque affectus hominum insinuavit, non
auro, non imperiis, sed morborum remediis? Quod ille nutu
fecit, nempe deus, hoc medicus pro virili sua cura imitatur.
Neque deest his quoque divina vis, nimirum medendi
viribus in hunc usum rebus a deo inditis. Nec alio viatico
magis instruxit Apostolos, mandans ut hoc protinus officio
sibi devincirent hospitem, medentes inquit, morbis illorum,
et ungentes oleo. *Paulus medicus.* Paulus ille magnus
dum Timetheo suo modicum vini praescribit usum, ad
fulciendam stomachi imbecillitatem, nonne palam medici
partibus utitur? *Raphael.* Sed quid hoc mirum in
Apostolo, cum Raphael angelus Tobiae caecitati medicans
hinc nomen etiam invenerit apud arcanarum rerum
studiosos? O coelestem vereque sacram disciplinam, cuius
cognomento divinae illae mentes insigniuntur.

Inter mortales alii alias artes vel discunt, vel profitentur,
hanc unam oportebat ab omnibus disci, quae nulli non est
necessaria. Sed o heu perversissima hominum judicia.

Nemo nescire sustinet, quis nummus legitimus sit, quis
adulterinus, ne quid fallatur in re vilissima, nec scire studio
est, quibus modis id quod habet optimum tueatur. In
numismate non credit alienis oculis, in negotio vitae ac
sanitatis, clausis quod dicitur oculis, sequitur alienum
judicium. Quod si totius artis absoluta cognitio non potest

nisi paucis contingere, qui totam vitam huic uni studio
dedicarunt, certe partem eam, quae ad tuendam
valetudinem pertinet, non conveniebat quemquam nescire.
Etiam si bona pars difficultatis, non ab ipsa arte, sed ab
improborum medicorum vel inscitia, vel ambitione
proficiscatur.

A simili. Semper apud efferas etiam ac barbaras nationes
sanctum ac venerabile fuit amicitiae nomen. Atque is
egregius habetur amicus, qui se fortunae utriusque
comitem sociumque praebeat, quod vulgus amicorum velut
hirundines aestate, rebus secundis adsunt, rebus adversis,
quemadmodum illae ingruente bruma devolant.

Seleucides. At quanto sincerior amicus medicus, qui
Seleucidum avium exemplo, quas narrant nusquam a Casii
montis incolis conspici, nisi cum illarum praesidio est
opus, adversus vim locustarum fruges vastantium, rebus
integris ac laetis nusquam sese ingerit, in periculis, in his
casibus, in quibus uxor ac liberi saepe deserunt hominem,
velut in phrenesi, phthiriasi, in peste solus medicus
constanter adest, et adest non inutili officio,
quemadmodum plerique caeterorum, sed adest
opitulaturus, adest pro capite periclitantis cum morbo
dimicans, nonnunquam suo quoque periculo. Et o plus
quam ingratos, qui talis amici officio servati, jam depulso
periculo medicum odisse possunt, ac non potius parentis
vice colunt ac venerantur. Vulgarem amicum, qui subinde
salutat obvium, ad coenam rogant, qui latus claudit, officio
pensant, et talem amicum ubi desierint egere, aversantur?
Et ob hoc ipsum aversantur, quod intelligant illius officio
nullam meritis parem gratiam rependi posse.

Quod si is optimus vir est, qui maxime prodest
Reipublicae, ars haec optimo cuique viro discenda est.

[Siquidem inter munia profani magistratus non minima
portio est, et haud scio an praecipua, dare operam, ut

corpora civium bene habeant. Quid prodest depulisse hostem a moenibus, si pestilentia intus grassans, plures tollit quam sublaturus erat gladius? Quid refert curasse ne cui pereat census, si perit prospera corporis valetudo? Prisci qui bonorum ordines digesserunt, primas tribuunt bonae valetudini. Quid enim prodest incolumis possessio, nisi valet possessor? Proinde leges priscorum, cum nondum quaestus et ambitio corrupisset omnia, potissimum huc spectabant, ut corpora civium essent valida, robusta, beneque temperata. Ea res partim pendet a nativitate, partim ab educatione, partim ab exercitamentis, et victus ratione, nonnihil etiam ab aedificiorum modo. Nimirum medici fungebantur officio, qui bene temperata corpora jungebant matrimonio, qui nutrices adhibebant integrae valetudinis, qui balnea publica, qui publica gymnasmata instituebant, qui ferebant leges sumptuarias, qui mutatis aedificiis, qui siccatis paludibus pestilentiam excluderant, qui in hoc vigilabant, ne quid esculentum aut poculentum venderetur, quod laederet corporum incolumitatem. Et hodie principes fere nihil ad se pertinere credunt, si pro vinis vendantur venena, si tritico vitiato, si putribus piscibus tot morbi invehantur in publicum.

Adeo nulla vitae pars est, quae citra medicinae praesidia recte possit administrari.]

A quaestu. Iam vero si qui sint, qui rerum pretia malint utilitate quaestuque metiri (licet haec ars divinior est, quam ut huiusmodi rationibus sit aestimanda) ne hac quidem parte cuiquam aliarum cedit artium. Neque enim ulla magis fuit frugifera, et ad rem subito parandam aequae praesentanea. Erasistratus cuius ante memini, a rege Ptolemaeo, Critobolus ab Alexandro magno, praemiis ingentibus ac vix credendis donati leguntur. Quamquam quod tandem praemium non exiguum videatur, repensum servatori capitis, pro cuius unius salute tot hominum millia depugnabant? Quid ego nunc commemorem Cassios,

Carpitanos, Aruncios, Albutios, quibus Romae tum apud principem, tum apud populum immodicum quaestum fuisse refert Plinius? Quanquam quid nos haec ex priscis aetatibus repetimus, quasi non hodie cuique complures succurrant, quos haec ars ad Croesi opes evexerit?

Rhetorica aut Poetica non alit nisi insignem. Musicus ni praecellat, esurit. Iureconsulto tenuis proventus est, ni sit eximius. Sola medicina quomodocunque doctum alit ac tuetur. Innumeris disciplinis, infinita rerum cognitione constat res medica, et tamen frequenter unum aut alterum remedium alit idiotam. Tantum abest, ut haec ars sterilitatis damnari possit.

Adde quod caeterarum artium non ubique paratus est quaestus. Rhetor frigebit apud Sarmatas, juris Caesarei peritus apud Britannos. Medicum quoquo terrarum sese contulerit suus comitatur honos, suum sequitur viaticum, ut in nullam disciplinam verius competat vulgatissimum illud Graecorum proverbium, το τεχνιον η̃ε πασα γ̃ε τρεπhei.

Confutatio. Sed hoc ipsum indignatur Plinius, aut certe apud hunc alii, quaestum esse medicinae professionem. Maior est, fateor, haec facultas quam ut quaestui lucroque serviat, sordidarum id est artium. Sed nimis ingratum est, eam solam sua fraudare gratia, cui nulla par gratia rependitur. Egregius medicus ceu numen quoddam, servat gratis, servat et invitos. Sed impietas est, non agnoscere numinis beneficium. Nihil ille moratur mercedem, tu tamen dignus qui legibus mulcteris ob insignem ingratitudinem.

Iam haudquaquam me fugit, hanc egregiam artem et olim apud veteres audisse male, et hodie apud indoctos quosdam male audire. Catoni non placuit, non quod rem damnaret, sed quod ambitiosam Graecorum professionem non ferret homo mere Romanus. Isque tantum tribuit experientiae, ut artem esse noluerit, sed idem universam Graecorum

philosophiam ex urbe pellendam censuit. Existimabat homo durus, ad purgandum hominis corpus sufficere brassicam et crebros vomitus, et tamen ille ipse medicorum hostis observatione medicinae, in extremam usque senectutem robur infractum tutatus scribitur.

Solis, inquiunt, medicis summa occidendi impunitas est. At hoc nomine magis suspiciendi boni medici, quibus cum in manu sit, non solum impune, verum etiam mercede occidere, tamen servare malunt. Quod possunt facultatis est, quod nolunt probitatis. Decantatur iam passim inter pocula temulentorum adagium, Qui medice vivit, misere vivit. Quasi vero felicitas sit, distendi crapula, rumpi Venere, turgescere cervisia, sepeliri somno. Sed istos Sycophantas quid opus est oratione refellere, cum ipsi petulantiae suae satis magnas poenas dant arti, mox podagra contorti, paralysi stupidi, desipiscentes ante tempus, caecutientes ante senectutem, iamque prius vituperatae medicinae, exemplo Stesichori, seram canunt palinodiam miseri. Et tamen his licet indignissimis, artis bonitas non gravatur esse praesidio, quantum licet. *Ex Aristophane.* Sunt qui, mutuato ex vetere comoedia scommate, vocent medicos skatophagous. Quasi vero non isto nomine vel praecipue laudari mereantur, qui quo subveniant hominum calamitatibus, ex illa sua sublimitate sese ad haec sordida dejiciant. Quod si medicis tantum esset supercilii, quantum istis est procacitatis, liceret passim impune mori. Verum habet hoc ars nostra cum bonis regibus commune, ut bene faciat ac male audiat.

Quod si maxime sunt, ut sunt in hoc ordine, qui se pro medicis gerunt, cum nihil minus sint quam medici. Si sunt qui pro remediis venena ministrant, si sunt qui ob quaestum et ambitionem aegrotis male consulunt, quid iniquius est, quam hominum vitia in artis calumniam detorquere? Sunt et inter sacerdotes adulteri, inter monachos homicidae ac piratae, sed quid hoc ad

religionem per se optimam? Nulla tam sancta professio est, quae non alat sceleratos aliquot. Votis quidem omnibus optandum, omnes principes eiusmodi esse, cuiusmodi decet esse, qui censeantur hoc digni nomine. Nec tamen ideo damnandus est principatus, quod nonnulli sub eo titulo praedones rei publicae hostes agant. Optarim et ipse medicos omnes vere medicos esse, *Proverbium*. nec in his locum dari Graecorum proverbio, πολλοι boukentai pauroi de te gês arotêres. Optarim ab omnibus eam praestari sanctimoniam, quam Hippocrates sacramento verbis solennibus concepto a professoribus exigit. Neque tamen huc non enitendum est nobis, si id a plerisque negligi conspiciamus.

Sed quoniam huius argumenti tanta est ubertas, viri praestantissimi, ut difficillimum sit in eo dicendi finem invenire, ne non praestem quod initio sum pollicitus, tempestivum arbitror, universas eius laudes summatim complecti.

Epilogus. Etenim si permultas res sola commendat antiquitas, hanc artem primam omnium reperit necessitas. Si scientiam autores illustrant, huius inventio semper diis attributa est. Si quid autoritatis addit honos, non alia tam passim ac tam diu divinos honores meruit. Si magni fiunt, quae summis viris probantur, haec summos reges, haec primates non solum delectavit, verum etiam illustravit. Si difficilia quae sunt, ea sunt et pulchra, nihil hac operosius, quae tot disciplinis, tantarum rerum pervestigatione usuque constat. Si dignitate rem aestimamus, quid excellentius, quam ad dei benignitatem proxime accedere? Si facultate, quid potentius aut efficacius quam totum hominem certo exitio perituro sibi posse restituere? Si necessitate, quid aequè necessarium atque id sine quo nec vivere, nec nasci licet? Si virtute, quid honestius, quam servare genus humanum? Si utilitate, nullius usus neque maior est, neque

latius patet. Si compendio, aut haec in primis frugifera sit oportet, aut ingratissimi mortales.

Vobis igitur magnopere gratulor, eximii viri, quibus contingit in hoc pulcherrimo genere professionis excellere.

Vos adhortor, optimi juvenes, hanc toto pectore complectimini, in hanc nervis omnibus incumbite, quae vobis decus, gloriam, auctoritatem, opes est conciliatura, per quam vos vicissim amicis, patriae, atque adeo mortalium generi non mediocrem utilitatem estis allaturi.

Dixi.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK ENCOMIUM
ARTIS MEDICAE ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to

you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:
www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.